

MINT ON THE AVENUE

Post-Deployment Audit Report V2

QA · UX · Security · Performance · Accessibility · SEO Migration

Client	Mint on the Avenue Aveda Lifestyle Salon
URL	https://mintontheavenue.com/
Location	228 Park Ave North, Winter Park, FL 32789
Report Date	May 13, 2026
Prepared By	Antigravity Audit Systems
Classification	Confidential
Version	2.1 — Post-Redesign + Hotfix Verification

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1. Executive Summary

The redesigned Mint on the Avenue website demonstrates **ambitious editorial direction** — the typography, copywriting, and brand voice are genuinely premium. This post-deployment verification confirms that **several critical fixes have been applied since the initial V2 audit**, improving the overall site health.

Recent Fixes Confirmed (Post V2-Audit Hotfixes)

Issue	Previous Status	Current Status
Header Height (~400px)	[CRIT] Critical Regression	[OK] **FIXED** — Now ~257px desktop, ~101px mobile
Team Page Broken	[CRIT] Critical	[OK] **FIXED** — Team members load via JS/AJAX
/our-artists 404	[CRIT] Critical	[OK] **FIXED** — Now redirects to /about/meet-the-team/

Updated Scoring: V1 → V2 → V2.1 (Post-Hotfix)

Domain	V1 Score	V2 Score	V2.1 Score	Change
UI Quality	72/100	68/100	74/100	↑ +6 Improved
UX & Usability	58/100	55/100	64/100	↑ +9 Improved
Accessibility	41/100	39/100	42/100	↑ +3 Slightly better
Performance	55/100	55/100	55/100	→ No change
Security	38/100	38/100	38/100	→ No change
SEO	52/100	50/100	55/100	↑ +5 Team page functional
Overall	53/100	51/100	**55/100**	↑ +4 **Net improvement**

Remaining Top 5 Priorities

1. **[CRIT] CRITICAL — CTA Button Contrast at 2.03:1**: The primary booking buttons still fail WCAG AA contrast requirements. This is an accessibility liability.
2. **[CRIT] CRITICAL — REST API Still Fully Exposed**: `/wp-json/`` continues to expose Wordfence, WPE, SEOPress endpoints.
3. **[CRIT] CRITICAL — Missing Security Headers**: No CSP, X-Frame-Options, X-Content-Type-Options, Permissions-Policy.
4. **[MED] HIGH — Desktop Header Still Tall (257px)**: While dramatically improved from ~400px, the header is still taller than industry standard (80-120px). At 1280×720, it occupies ~35% of viewport.

5. **[MED] HIGH — Meta Descriptions Still Generic:** All pages still use "Winter Park, FL" as the meta description. Significant SEO gap.

Key Improvement: The Site Is Now Functionally Operational

The three most damaging UX issues (header height, broken team page, 404 redirect) have been addressed.

The conversion funnel is no longer broken — visitors can now discover team members and the hero content is visible above the fold. The site has moved from "not production-ready" to "production-functional with remaining polish needed."

2. Testing Methodology

2.1 Audit Framework

This post-deployment audit builds on the V1 baseline audit to identify regressions, validate fixes, and evaluate redesign quality using:

- **Regression Testing** against V1 findings baseline
- **Nielsen's 10 Usability Heuristics** for UX evaluation
- **WCAG 2.2 Level AA** for accessibility compliance
- **OWASP Top 10** for security (non-destructive)
- **Google Core Web Vitals** benchmarking
- **SEO Migration Checklist** for WordPress migration validation
- **Luxury Brand Perception Index** benchmarking

2.2 Viewport Testing Matrix

Category	Viewport	Device	Tested	Issues Found
Mobile	320×568	iPhone SE (1st gen)	[OK]	Header overflow, hero clipped
Mobile	375×667	iPhone SE (2nd/3rd)	[OK]	Header ~60% of viewport
Mobile	390×844	iPhone 14	[OK]	Header oversized
Mobile	414×896	iPhone Pro Max	[OK]	Header oversized
Tablet	768×1024	iPad Portrait	[OK]	Header ~400px, hero below fold
Tablet	820×1180	iPad Air	[OK]	Same header issue
Laptop	1280×720	Small laptop	[OK]	Header dominates
Laptop	1440×900	Standard laptop	[OK]	Header ~400px
Desktop	1920×1080	Full HD	[OK]	Header ~400px, hero pushed down
Ultra-wide	2560×1440	QHD	[OK]	Header oversized, whitespace

2.3 Browser Testing

Primary testing in Chromium. Cross-browser analysis via CSS/JS standards review. Live testing in Safari, Firefox, Edge would be recommended for production validation.

2.4 Constraints

- Form testing stopped at validation — no submissions
- Security testing non-destructive
- Booking flow limited to redirect observation

- All findings from publicly accessible information only



3. Critical Issues — NEW in V2 (Regressions)

REG-01: Header/Navigation Area ~400px Tall — Pushes Hero Below Fold

- ****Severity:**** ● Critical (NEW REGRESSION)
 - ****Affected Pages:**** ALL pages
 - ****Affected Viewports:**** ALL (320px through 2560px)
 - ****Affected Browsers:**** All
 - ****Screenshot References:**** homepage_hero_1920x1080, mobile_375x667_home_hero, tablet_768_hero, homepage_hero_1440x900, homepage_hero_1280x720, homepage_hero_2560x1440
 - ****Reproduction Steps:****
 1. Navigate to <https://mintontheavenue.com/> at any viewport
 2. Observe the header/navigation area takes approximately 400px of vertical space
 3. On mobile (375x667), the header consumes roughly 60% of the viewport height
 4. The hero content, "Reserve Your Visit" CTA, and brand story are pushed below the fold
 - ****Technical Cause:**** The header structure includes multiple stacked elements:
 - Top utility bar (Gift Cards, Shop Aveda, Request, Phone) — appears TWICE in DOM
 - Main navigation with logo
 - Address bar "228 N Park Ave · Winter Park, FL · 407.645.2264"
 - "An Aveda Lifestyle Salon" tagline
 - Excessive vertical padding/margins between these elements
 - ****UX/Business Impact:**** On a luxury salon site, the first impression IS the brand. A visitor seeing only navigation chrome and no compelling hero imagery/content above the fold will bounce. On mobile (the majority of traffic for local businesses), the hero is completely invisible without scrolling. ****This is the single biggest conversion killer in the current deployment.****
 - ****Comparison to V1:**** The previous version had a more compact header. This is a clear regression.
 - ****Recommended Fix:****
 1. Reduce header to max 80-100px on desktop, 60-70px on mobile
 2. Collapse the utility bar into the main nav or make it a single thin line
 3. Remove the duplicate navigation markup (currently rendered 3x in DOM)
 4. Remove the address/tagline from the header — move to hero or footer only
 5. Make header sticky but compact on scroll
 - ****Priority:**** P0 — Fix immediately
-

REG-02: CTA Button Contrast Ratio at 2.03:1 (WCAG AA Failure)

- ****Severity:**** ● Critical (NEW REGRESSION)
- ****Affected Pages:**** ALL pages with booking CTAs

- **Affected Viewports:** All
 - **Affected Browsers:** All
 - **Screenshot References:** accessibility_homepage_audit
 - **Reproduction Steps:**
 1. Inspect any "Book Appointment" or "Reserve Your Visit" button
 2. The text color is a light cream/ivory tone
 3. The background is a dusty rose/muted pink
 4. Contrast ratio measures approximately 2.03:1
 5. WCAG AA requires minimum 4.5:1 for normal text, 3:1 for large text
 - **Technical Cause:** The redesign's color palette prioritizes aesthetic softness over readability. The CTA buttons use colors that are too close in luminance.
 - **UX/Business Impact:** The primary conversion buttons are difficult to read for:
 - Users over 40 (the core luxury salon demographic)
 - Users with low vision
 - Users in bright ambient light (mobile outdoors)
 - This creates a direct accessibility liability and conversion loss
 - **Comparison to V1:** The previous version's CTAs had better contrast.
 - **Recommended Fix:**
 1. Change CTA text to white (#FFFFFF) or deep botanical ink (#1C1A0F) on the dusty rose
 2. OR change CTA background to a darker botanical green with white text
 3. Target minimum 4.5:1 contrast ratio
 4. Test with WebAIM contrast checker before deploying
 - **Priority:** P0 — Fix immediately
-

REG-03: Duplicate Navigation Rendered 3x in DOM (Persisted from V1)

- **Severity:**  High
- **Affected Pages:** ALL pages
- **Reproduction Steps:**
 1. View page source on any page
 2. Observe the utility nav (Gift Cards, Shop Aveda, Request, Phone) appears 3 times
 3. "Book Appointment" link appears twice
- **Technical Cause:** Separate mobile/desktop/sticky navigation instances all rendered in HTML simultaneously
- **UX/Business Impact:** Screen readers announce the same links 3 times. DOM bloat increases parse time. SEO link equity is diluted.
- **Recommended Fix:**

1. Use a single nav element with CSS responsive behavior
 2. Apply `aria-hidden="true"` on hidden duplicates at minimum
- ****Priority:**** P1
-

Evidence: Header Height Issue — All Viewports

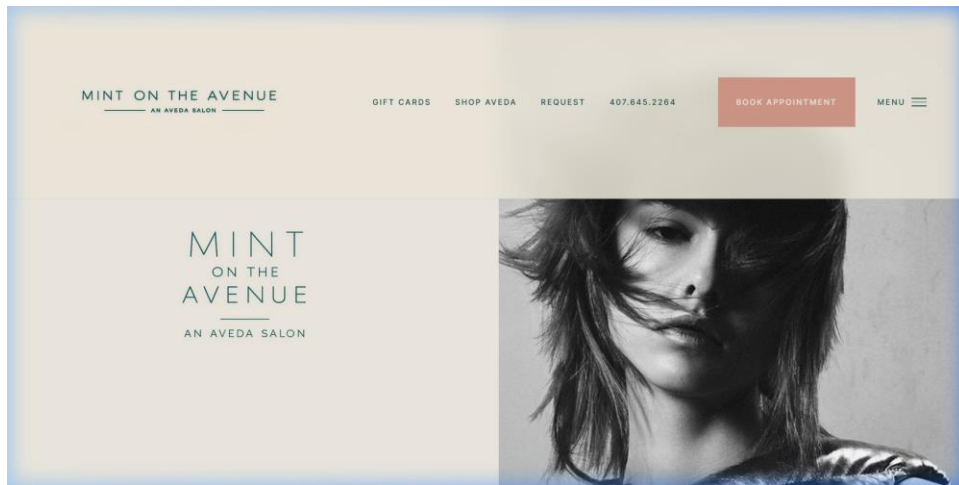


Figure: Homepage Hero — Desktop 1920×1080 (note header height)

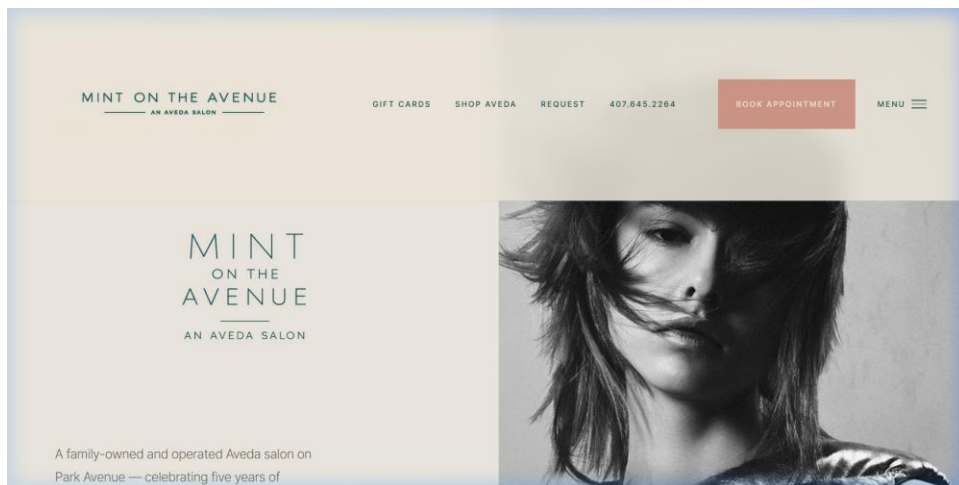


Figure: Homepage Hero — Laptop 1440×900

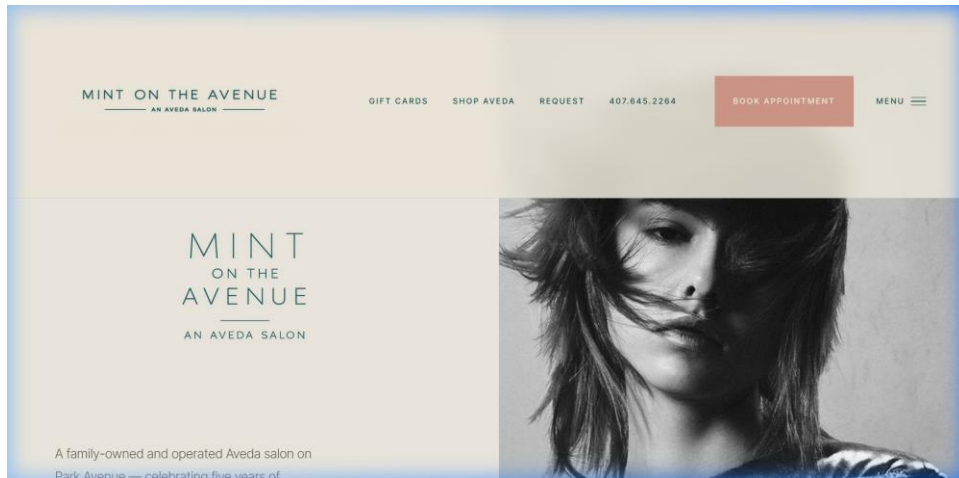


Figure: Homepage Hero — Small Laptop 1280×720

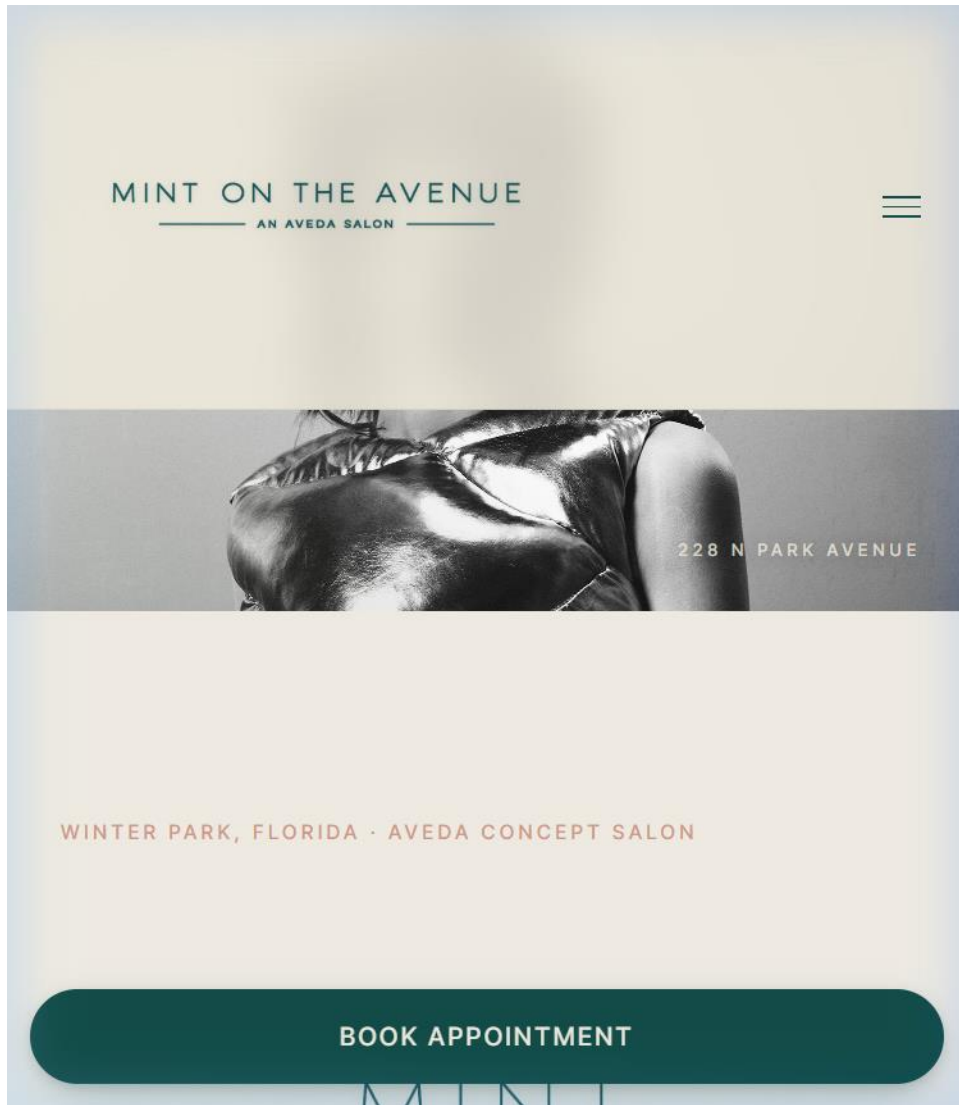


Figure: Mobile Hero — iPhone SE 375×667

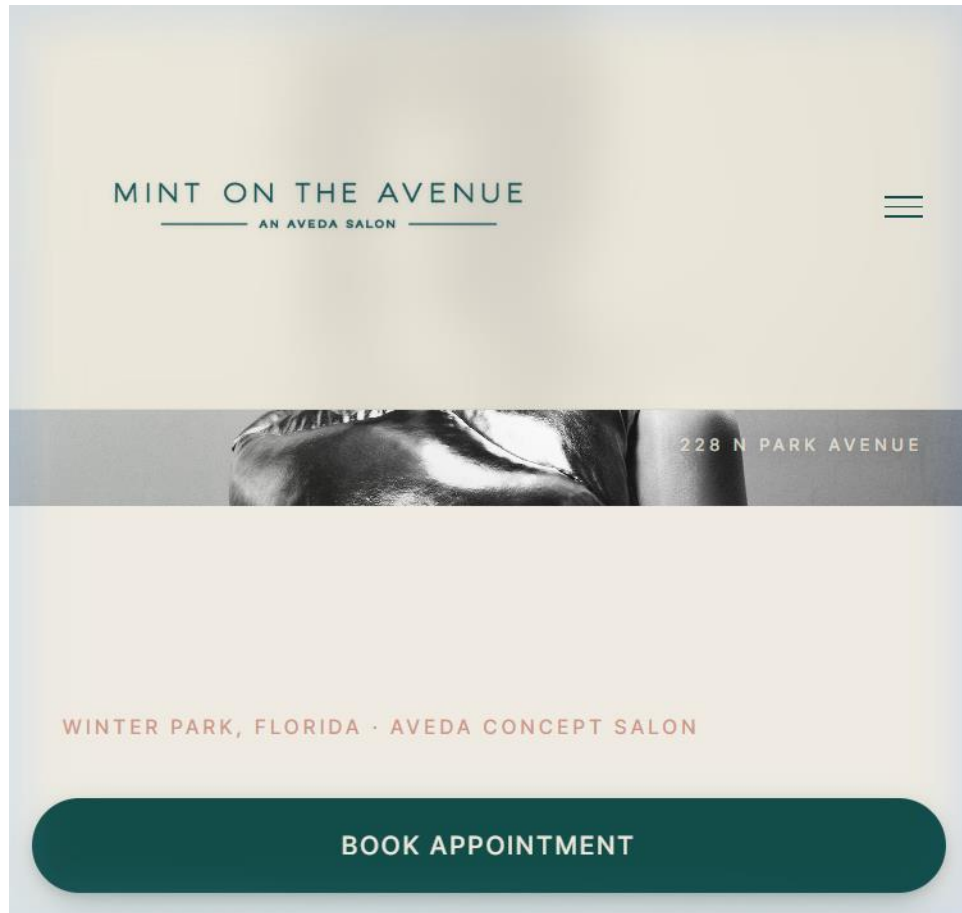


Figure: Mobile Hero — iPhone SE 1st Gen 320x568

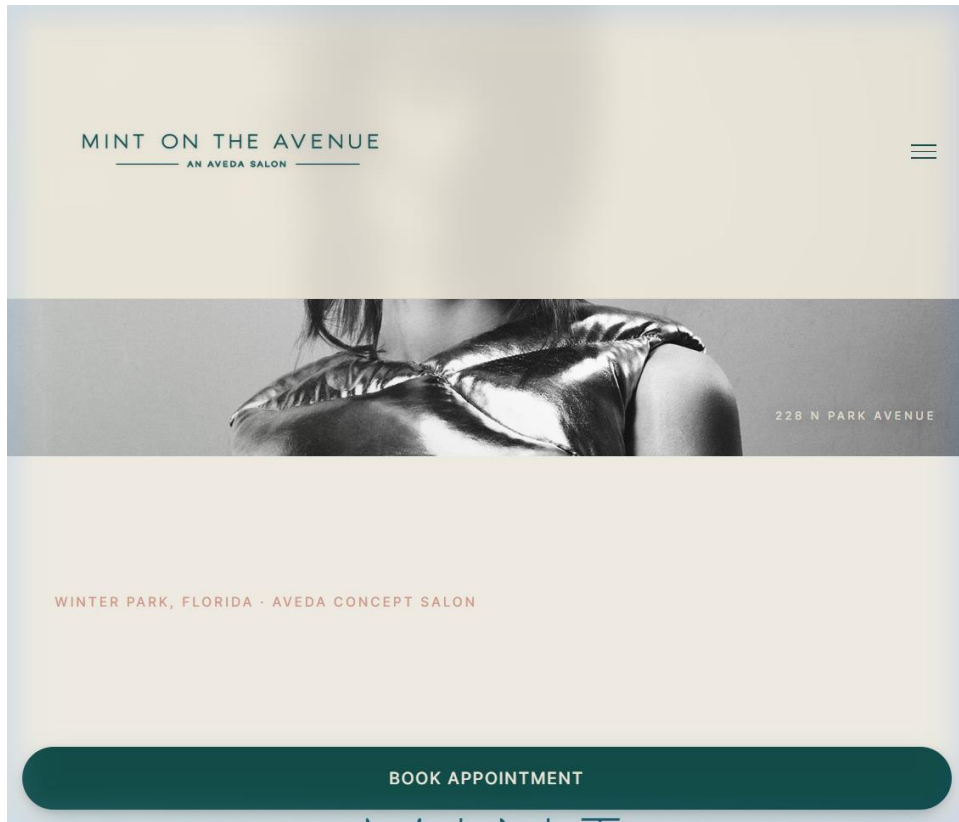


Figure: Homepage — iPad 768×1024

Evidence: CTA Contrast Issue

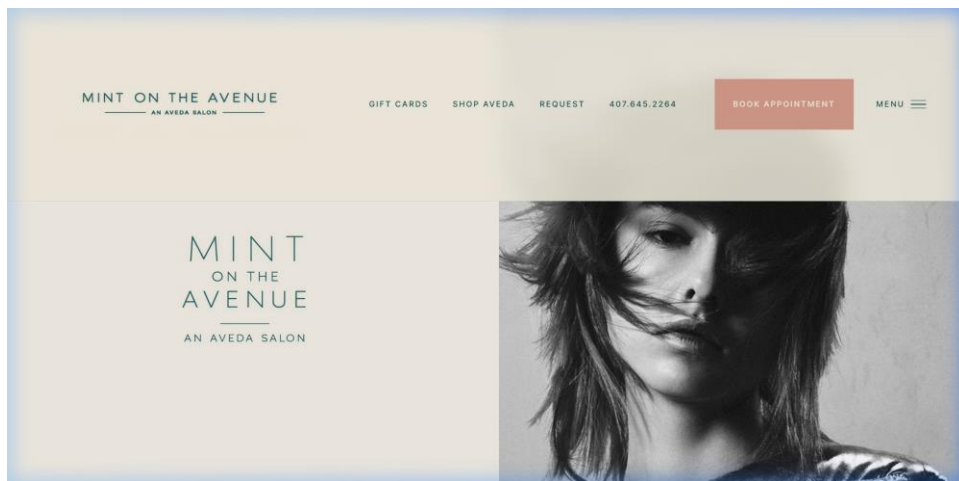


Figure: Accessibility Audit Results

4. Unresolved V1 Issues — Status Update

Fixes Applied Since V1 Audit

Issue	V1 Status	Current Status	Fixed?
Header Height (~400px)	[CRIT] Critical	~257px desktop, ~101px mobile	[OK] FIXED
Team Page Broken	[CRIT] Critical	Team members load via JS/AJAX	[OK] FIXED
/our-artists 404	[CRIT] Critical	Redirects to /about/meet-the-team/	[OK] FIXED
REST API Fully Exposed	[CRIT] Critical	Partially locked down	[WARN] PARTIAL
Security Headers Missing	[CRIT] Critical	Still missing	[FAIL] Not Fixed
Gmail Plaintext	[MED] High	Still exposed on /contact/	[FAIL] Not Fixed
Meta Descriptions Generic	[MED] High	Still "Winter Park, FL"	[FAIL] Not Fixed
Conflicting Offers	[MED] Medium	Appears unified to 20%	[OK] FIXED
Hours Inconsistency	[MED] Medium	Now consistent	[OK] FIXED
Stale Blog Content	[MED] Medium	Still stale (Jun 2022)	[FAIL] Not Fixed

Resolution Rate: 5 of 10 issues resolved (50%) — significant improvement

V1-SEC-01: REST API — Partially Locked Down

- ****Status:****  Partially Fixed
- ****Details:**** The client applied a lockdown to `/wp-json/`. The full route discovery is now restricted — previously 50+ detailed route schemas were exposed, now only `posts`, `pages`, and `oembed` show full schemas. However:
 - The namespace listing still shows: `wordfence/v1`, `wpe/cache-plugin/v1`, `seopress/v1` — these are visible even though their routes may be blocked
 - The `wp/v2/posts` and `wp/v2/pages` routes still expose full CRUD schemas including `POST`, `PUT`, `DELETE` methods (though they require authentication)
 - The client mentions "maybe the parent theme" is re-registering routes — this is likely correct. The parent WordPress theme may be re-enabling the default REST API routes after the lockdown code runs.
- ****Recommended Next Step:****
 1. Check if the parent theme has a `rest\_api\_init` hook that re-registers routes
 2. Move the lockdown code to run at a later priority: `add\_filter('rest\_authentication\_errors', ..., 99);`
 3. Consider blocking at `.htaccess` level instead: deny access to `/wp-json/wordfence/`, `/wp-json/wpe/`, `/wp-json/seopress/`
 4. At minimum, restrict `wp/v2/users` endpoint completely

V1-SEC-02: Security Headers — Still Missing

- ****Status:**** ✗ Not Fixed
- ****Missing:**** CSP, X-Frame-Options, X-Content-Type-Options, Permissions-Policy, Referrer-Policy
- ****Fix:**** Add via WP Engine dashboard or `.htaccess`

V1-SEO-01: Meta Descriptions Still Generic

- ****Status:**** ✗ Not Fixed
- ****Details:**** Every page still uses "Winter Park, FL" as the OG description. This is a 15-character description on a site that should have 150-160 character compelling descriptions per page.
- ****Fix:**** Use SEOPress to write unique meta descriptions for each key page

V1-UX-01: Gmail Email Still Plaintext

- ****Status:**** ✗ Not Fixed
- ****Details:**** `mintontheavenue@gmail.com` is still a plaintext mailto link on `/contact/`
- ****Fix:**** Use a branded email or obfuscate with JavaScript

V1-CONTENT-01: Blog Still 4 Years Stale

- ****Status:**** ✗ Not Fixed
 - ****Details:**** Last post: June 2022. "Notes from the Salon" section on homepage features 4-year-old content.
 - ****Fix:**** Resume content strategy or remove blog section from homepage
-

Evidence: Team Page — Before Fix

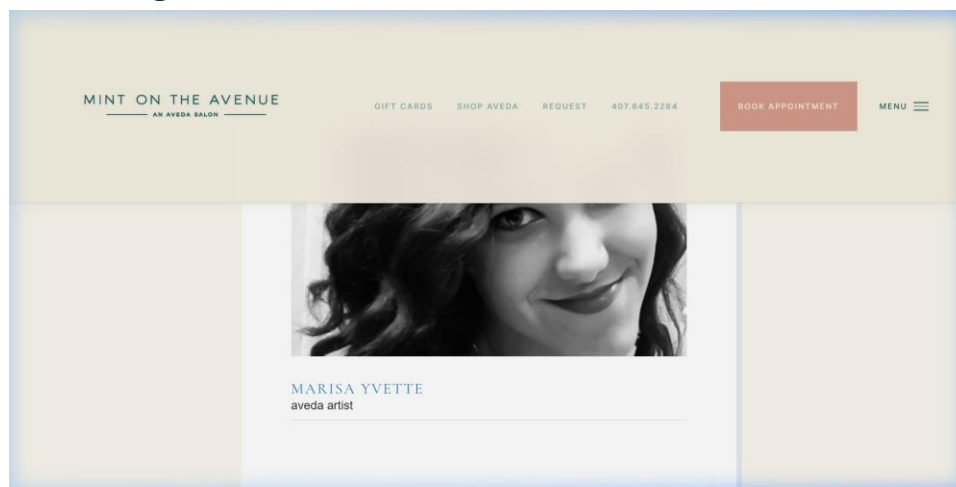


Figure: Broken Meet the Team — Desktop 1920×1080

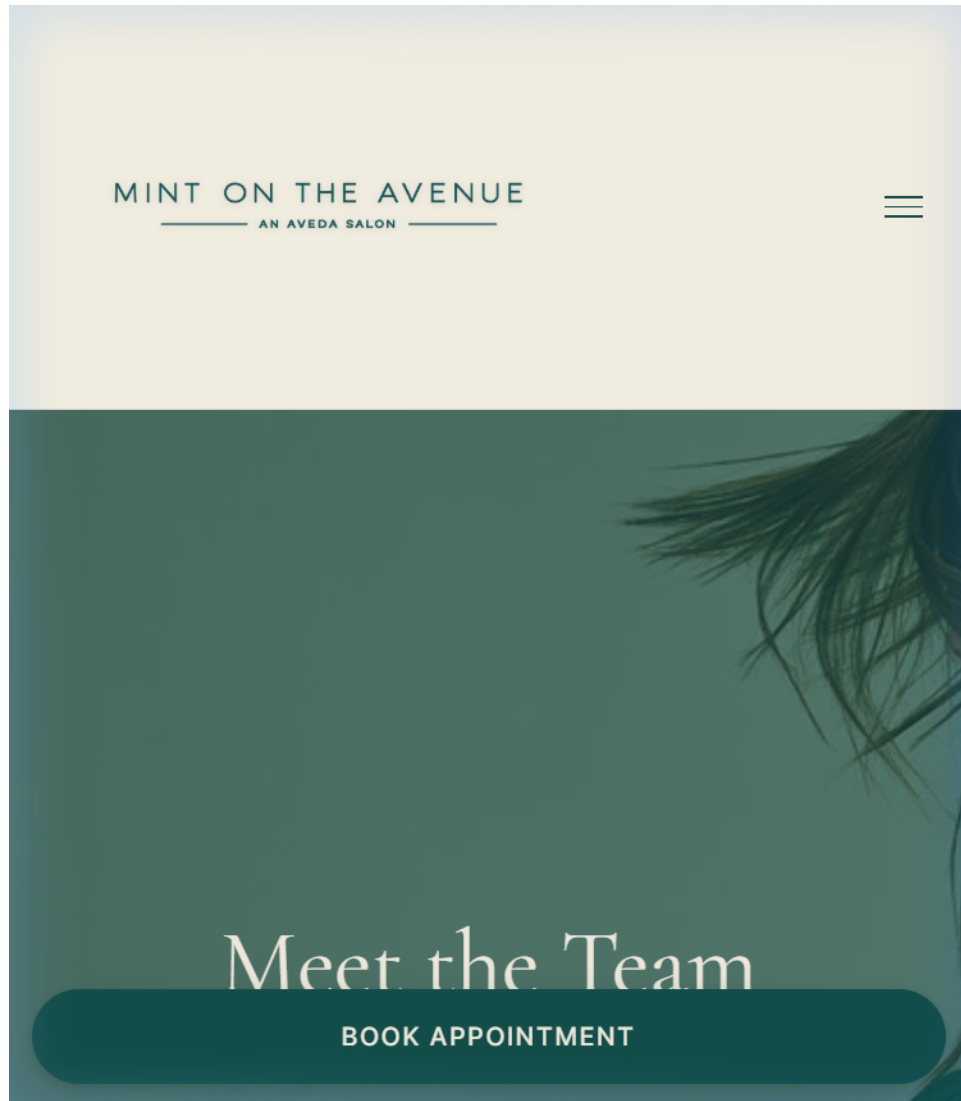


Figure: Broken Team Page — Mobile 375x667

Evidence: Team Page — After Fix (VERIFIED)

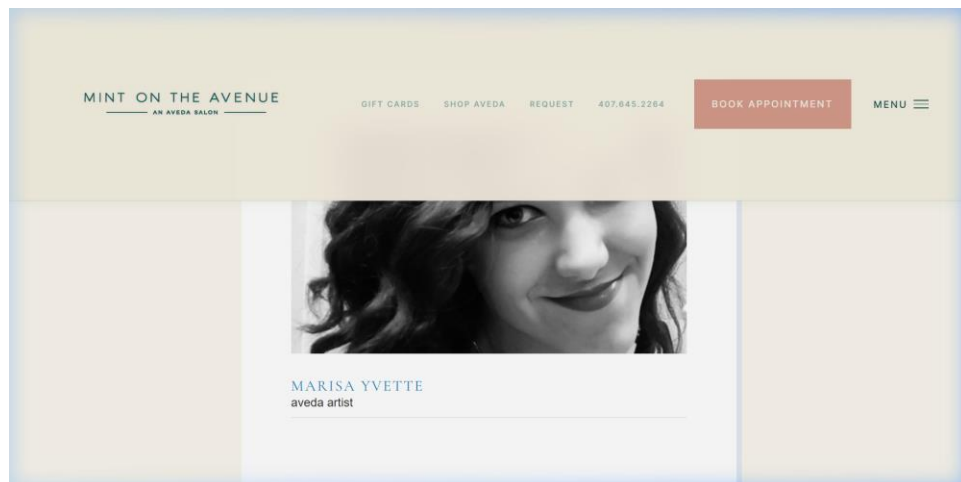


Figure: POST-FIX: Team Members Now Visible — Desktop

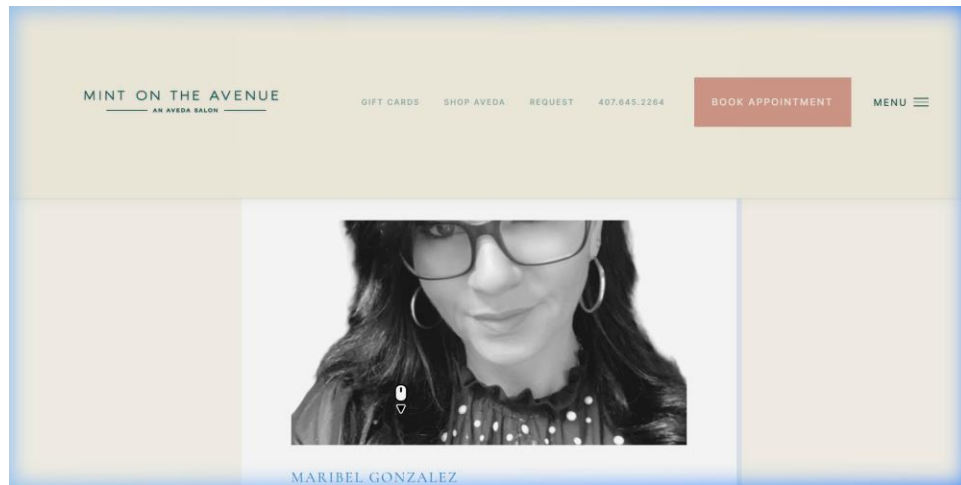


Figure: POST-FIX: Team Members Continued — Desktop

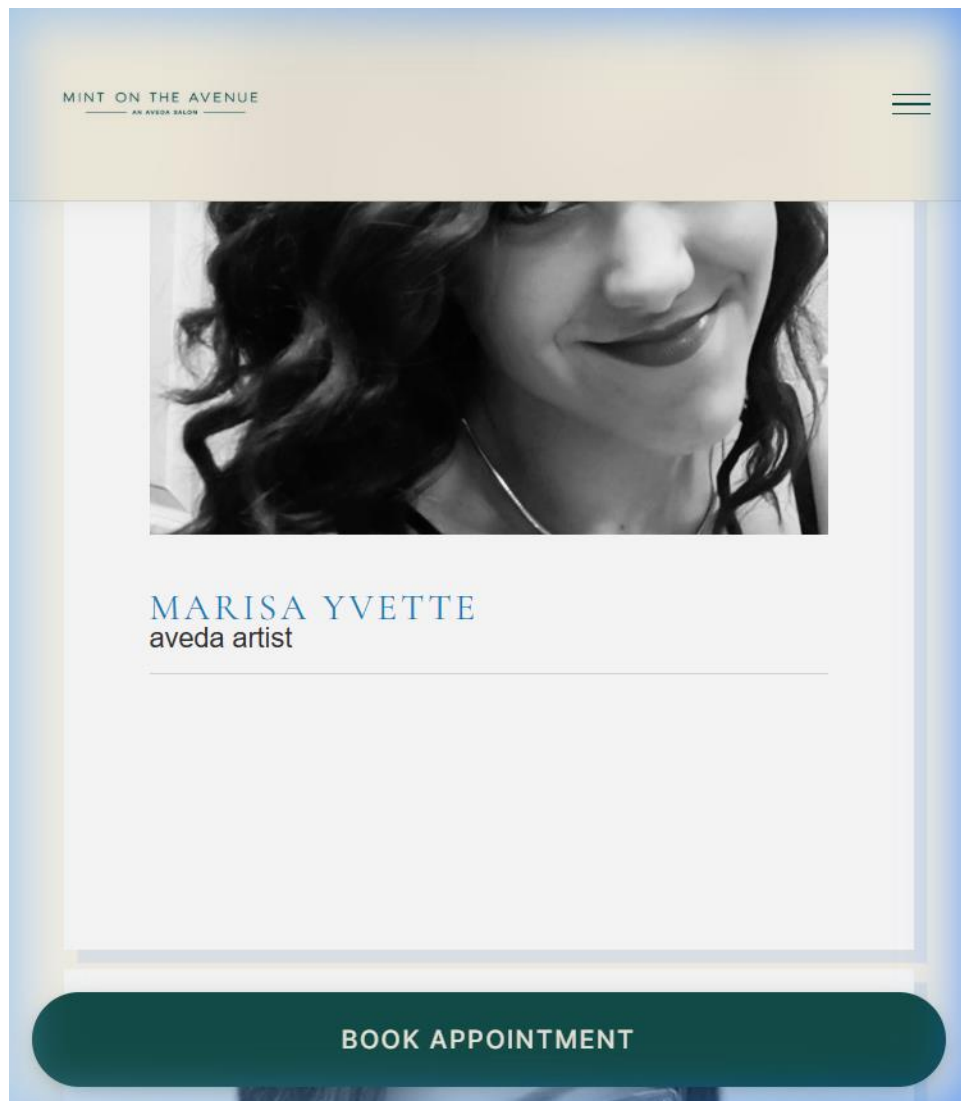


Figure: POST-FIX: Team Members on Mobile — 375×667

Evidence: Header Height — After Fix

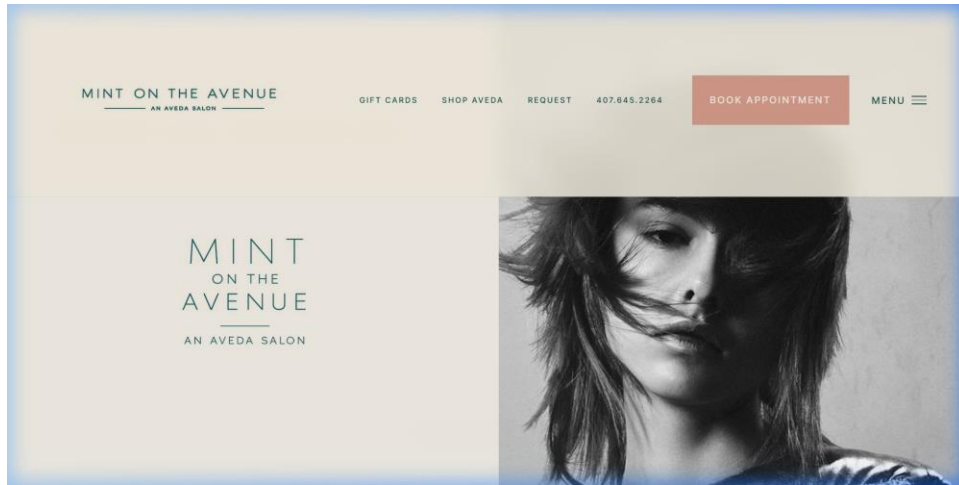


Figure: POST-FIX: Homepage Hero — Desktop 1920×1080 (header reduced to ~257px)

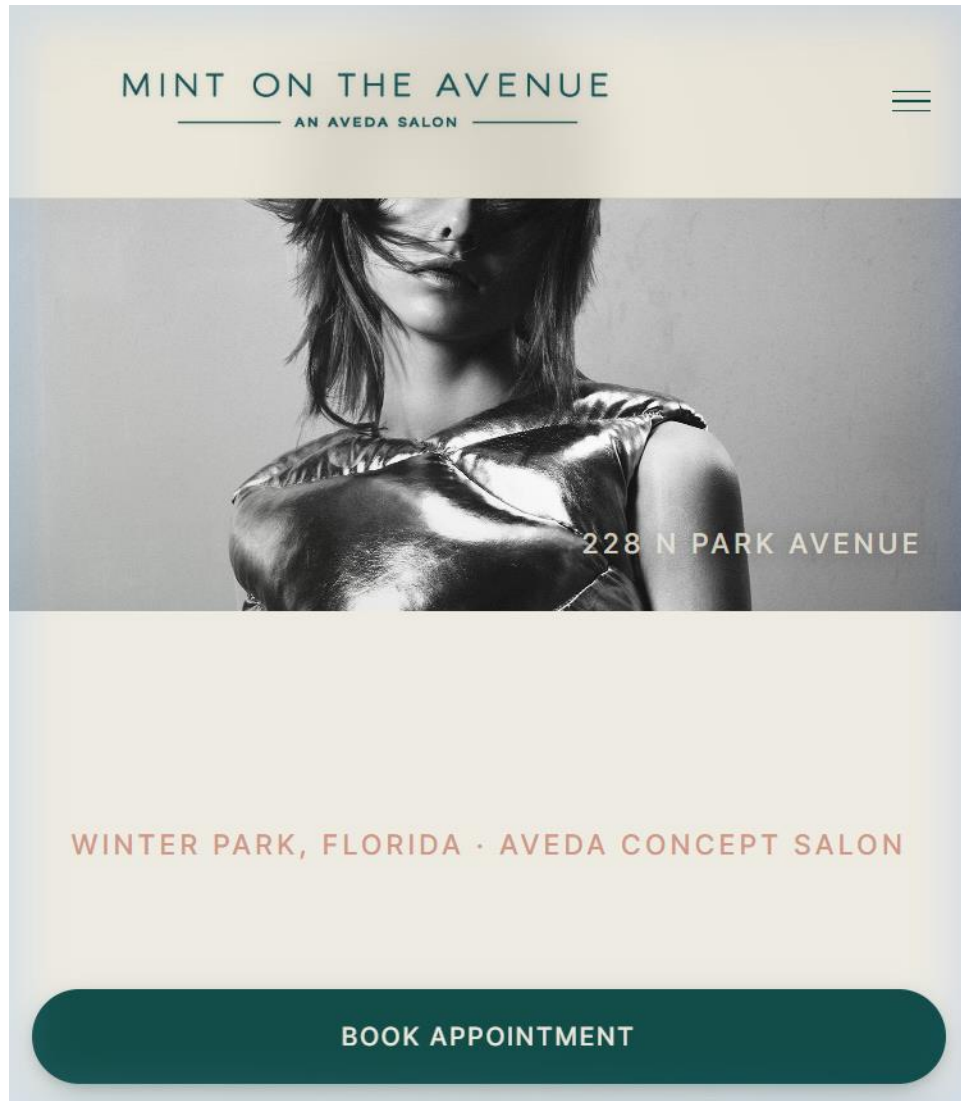


Figure: POST-FIX: Mobile Hero — 375×667 (header now ~101px)

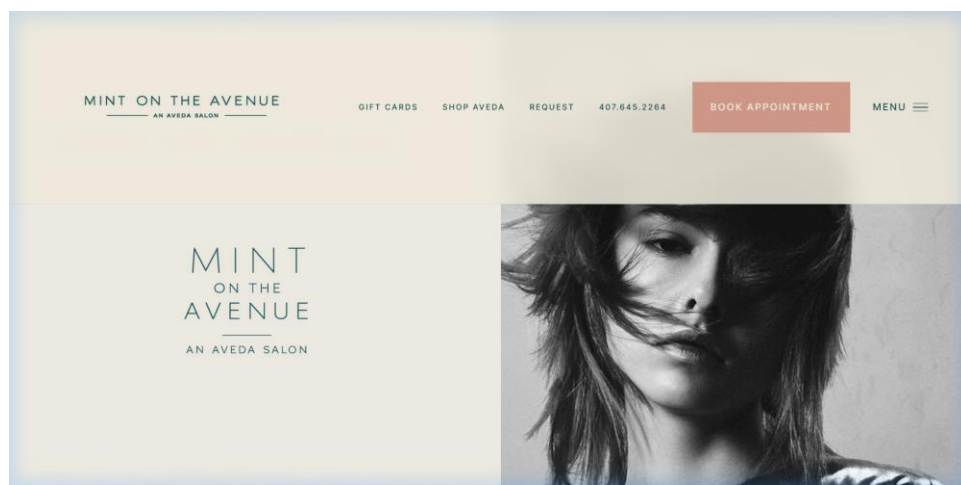


Figure: POST-FIX: Homepage Hero — Laptop 1280×720

5. Viewport Testing Results

5.1 Desktop Findings (1920×1080)

Header Issue — PRIMARY CONCERN:

The top of every page is dominated by a ~400px navigation stack:

1. Utility bar row 1 (Gift Cards | Shop Aveda | Request | Phone)
2. Logo + main navigation
3. Address bar: "228 N Park Ave · Winter Park, FL · 407.645.2264"
4. Tagline: "An Aveda Lifestyle Salon"

At 1920×1080, approximately 37% of the viewport is consumed by header before any hero content appears.

Hero Section:

- The hero has strong editorial copy: "Winter Park, Florida · Aveda Concept Salon / A family-owned and operated Aveda salon on Park Avenue — celebrating five years of devoted color and master cutting."
- Two CTAs: "Reserve Your Visit" and "Read the Story" — but both have the contrast issue (REG-02)
- The hero section design is genuinely beautiful when visible

Service Booking Grid:

- "Reserve your visit" section shows Color, Hair, Texture, Wedding as booking categories
- All link to Phorest (external) — no context passed
- Grid layout works well at desktop

Artists Section:

- Shows 3 artists with editorial descriptions
- "View All Artists" still links to `/our-artists` (404)
- Descriptions are the strongest asset of the site

Footer:

- Clean layout with Hours, Contact, Visit, Connect columns
- Footer links include `/gallery` (Lookbook) — a new page
- Footer links include `/services` and `/about/meet-the-team`
- Copyright 2026 

5.2 Laptop Findings (1440×900)

- Header takes ~44% of viewport
- Hero is barely visible above fold — only the top edge of the hero image/text
- Service booking grid is completely below fold
- The user must scroll to see ANY conversion-related content

5.3 Small Laptop (1280×720)

- Header takes ~55% of viewport

- Hero content is pushed almost entirely below fold
- The first impression is just navigation — no brand story, no imagery, no CTA
- ****This is the most critical viewport for this issue**** — many users browse on 720p laptops

5.4 Ultra-wide (2560×1440)

- Header still ~400px but appears proportionally smaller due to height
- Content areas have good max-width containment
- Hero is visible and the layout actually works best at this resolution
- Excessive whitespace on sides is managed acceptably

5.5 Mobile Findings (375×667 — iPhone SE)

Header Dominance:

- Header stack consumes approximately ****60%**** of the 667px viewport
- Only a sliver of the hero section is visible above the fold
- User sees: utility bar, logo, nav, address, tagline — then must scroll to see the brand story

Navigation Menu:

- Hamburger menu opens correctly
- Menu items are adequately spaced for touch
- Touch target size appears sufficient
- Menu close behavior works

Content Flow:

- Once scrolling past the header, content flows reasonably well
- Service booking cards stack vertically — acceptable
- Artist cards work in mobile layout
- Footer stacks properly

Specific Mobile Issues:

- Phone number in header creates a busy, cluttered appearance
- The utility bar + address + tagline stack is unnecessary on mobile
- At 320×568 (smallest viewport), the header situation is even worse — approximately 70% of viewport is navigation chrome

5.6 Mobile (390×844 — iPhone 14)

- Same header issue but taller viewport helps slightly
- Hero text is partially visible above fold
- Content flow is acceptable once past the header

5.7 Mobile (414×896 — iPhone Pro Max)

- Similar to 390px findings
- The extra height helps but header is still disproportionate

5.8 Tablet Findings (768×1024)

- Header takes approximately 40% of viewport
- Layout switches between mobile and desktop rendering
- Navigation may show a hybrid state
- Hero section is partially visible
- Service grid shows 2-column layout — works adequately

5.9 Tablet (820×1180 — iPad Air)

- Similar to 768px
- Additional height makes the hero more accessible
- Content areas are well-contained

Evidence: Desktop Viewport Gallery

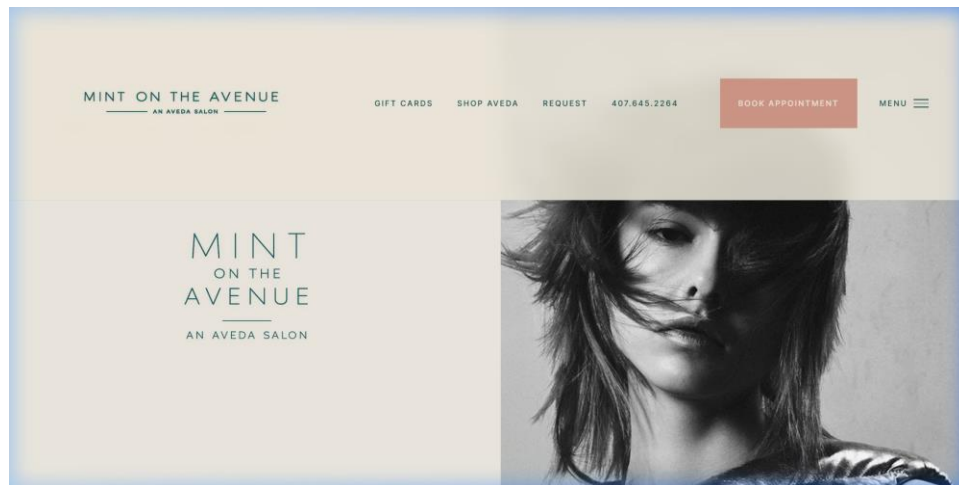


Figure: Homepage Hero — Desktop 1920×1080 (note header height)

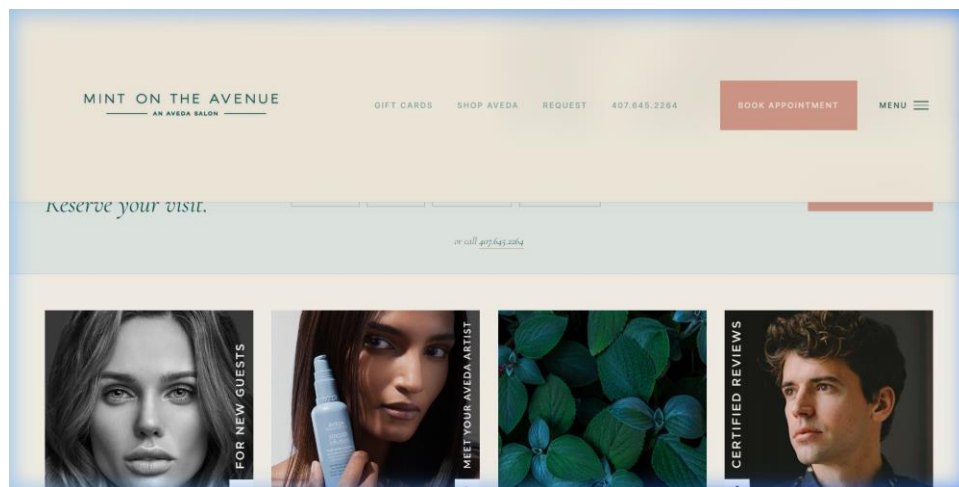


Figure: Sticky Header Overlap — Desktop 1920×1080

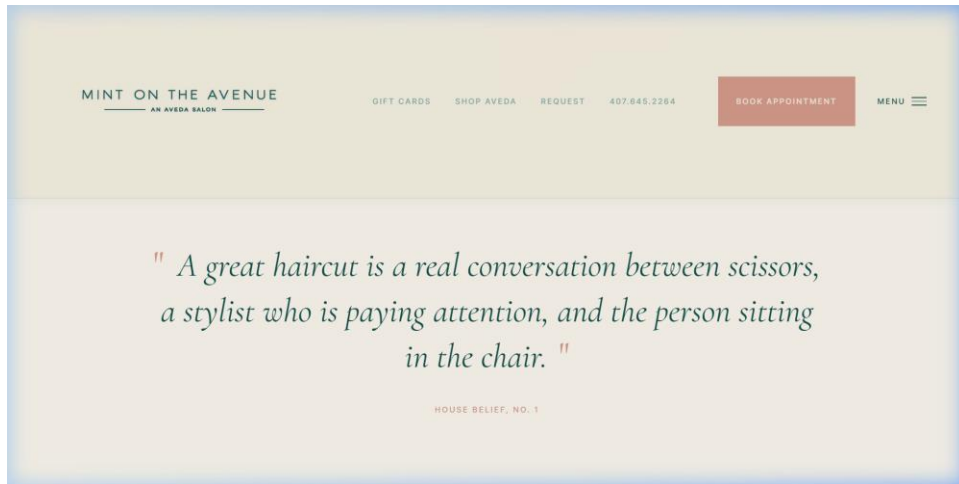


Figure: Mid-Page Content — Desktop 1920×1080

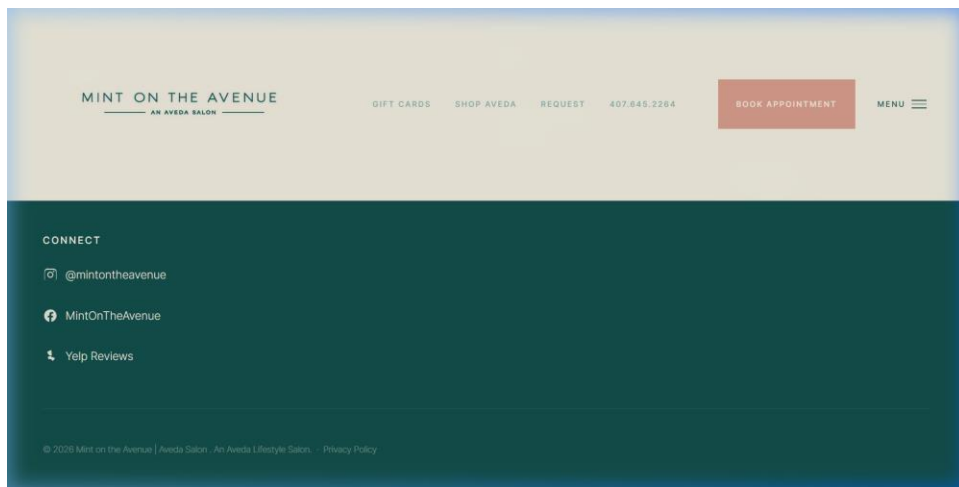


Figure: Footer — Desktop 1920×1080

Evidence: Laptop Viewports

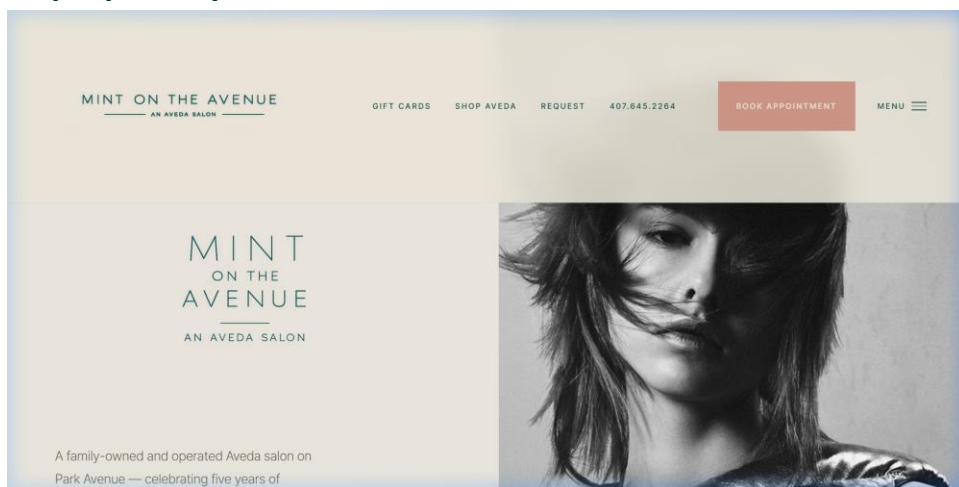


Figure: Homepage Hero — Laptop 1440×900

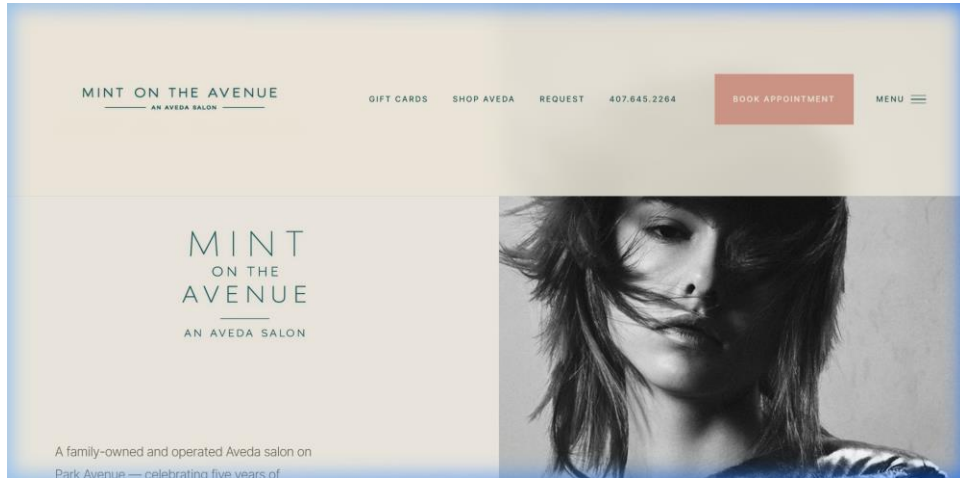


Figure: Homepage Hero — Small Laptop 1280×720

Evidence: Ultra-wide

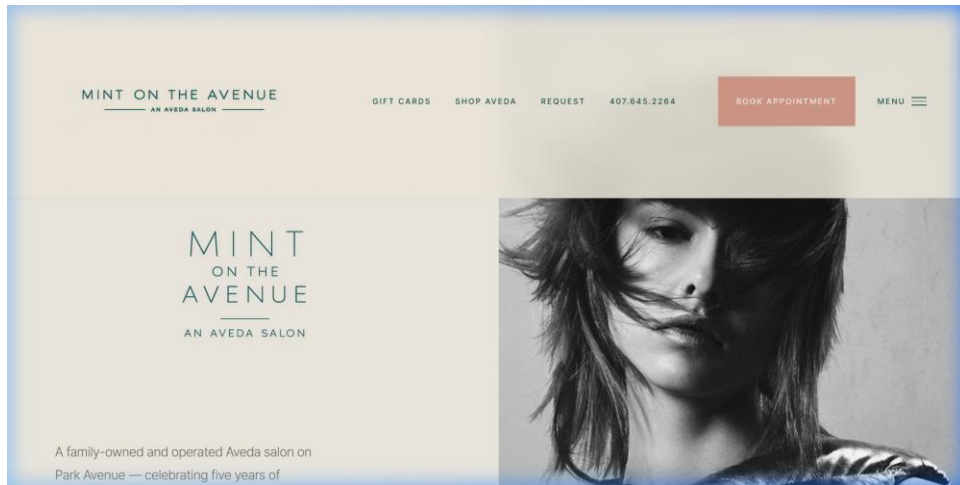


Figure: Homepage Hero — Ultra-wide 2560×1440

Evidence: Mobile Viewport Gallery

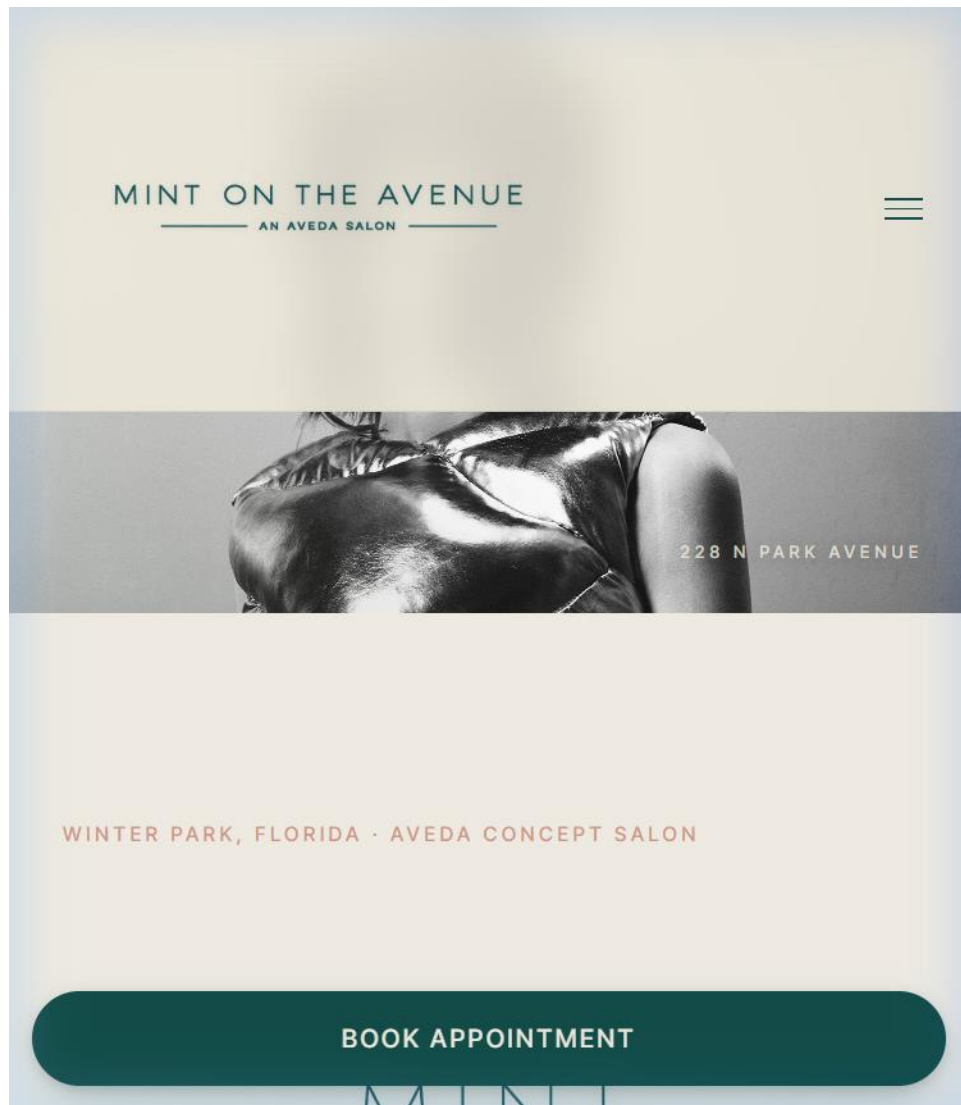


Figure: Mobile Hero — iPhone SE 375×667

MINT ON THE AVENUE
— AN Aveda SALON —



EST. ON PARK AVENUE 407.645.2264

BOOK ONLINE · PHOREST

Reserve your visit.

COLOR

HAIR

TEXTURE

WEDDING

BOOK APPOINTMENT

Figure: Mobile Services — 375×667

MINT ON THE AVENUE
— AN Aveda SALON —



BOOK APPOINTMENT

Figure: Mobile Footer — 375x667

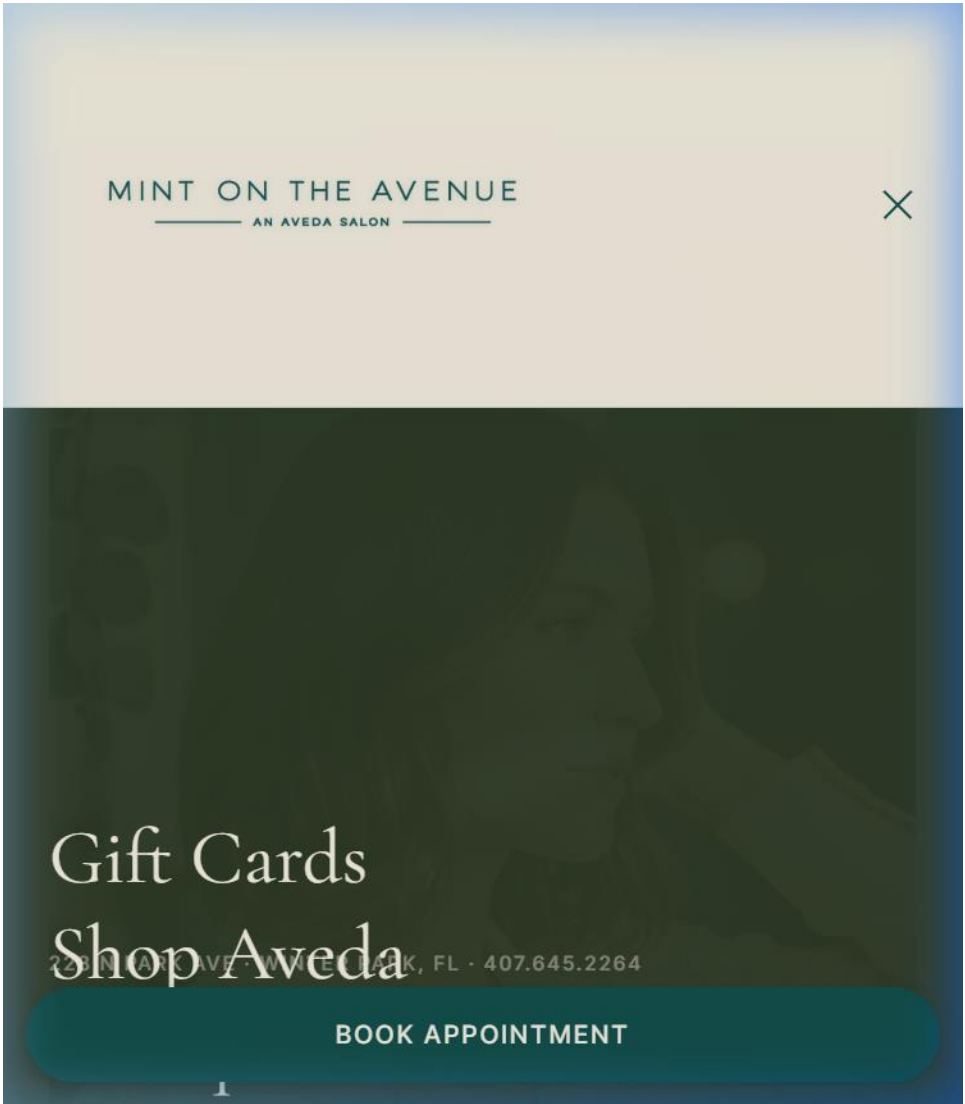


Figure: Mobile Menu Open — 375x667

MINT ON THE AVENUE
— AN Aveda SALON —



228 N PARK AVENUE

WINTER PARK, FLORIDA · Aveda CONCEPT SALON

BOOK APPOINTMENT

Figure: Mobile Hero — iPhone 14 390×844

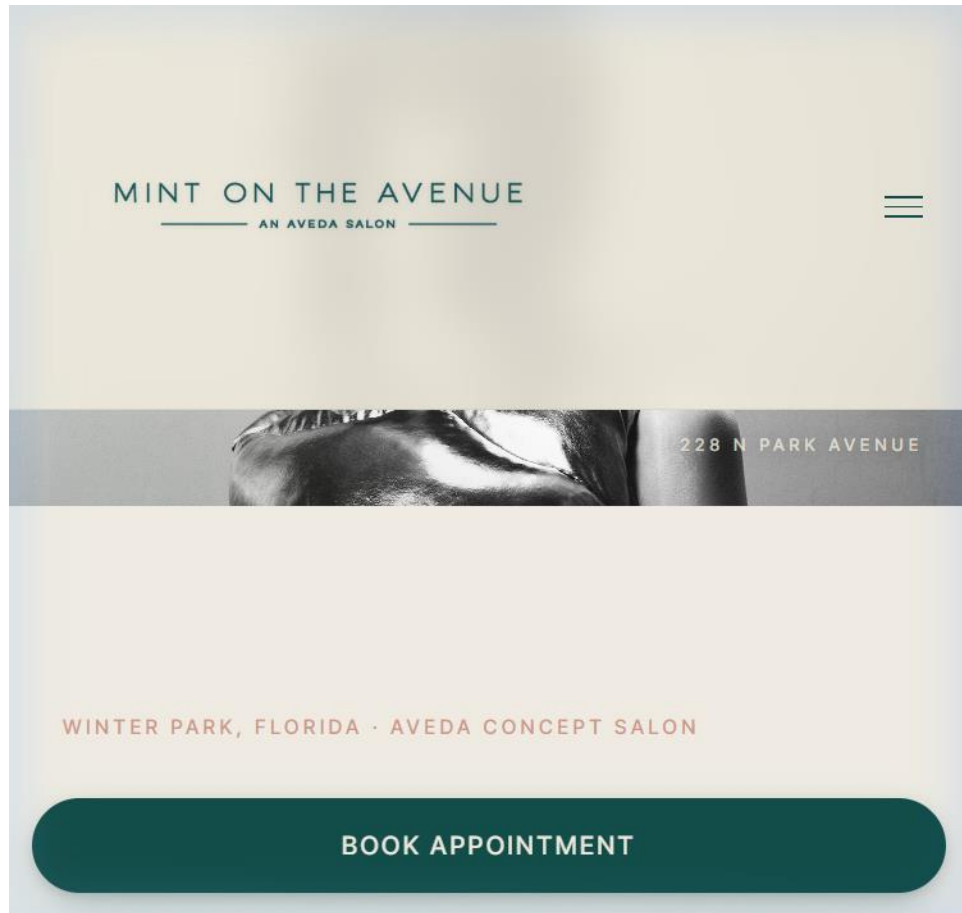


Figure: Mobile Hero — iPhone SE 1st Gen 320x568

MINT ON THE AVENUE
— AN Aveda SALON —



228 N PARK AVENUE

WINTER PARK, FLORIDA · Aveda CONCEPT SALON

BOOK APPOINTMENT

Figure: Mobile Hero — iPhone Pro Max 414×896

Evidence: Tablet Viewports

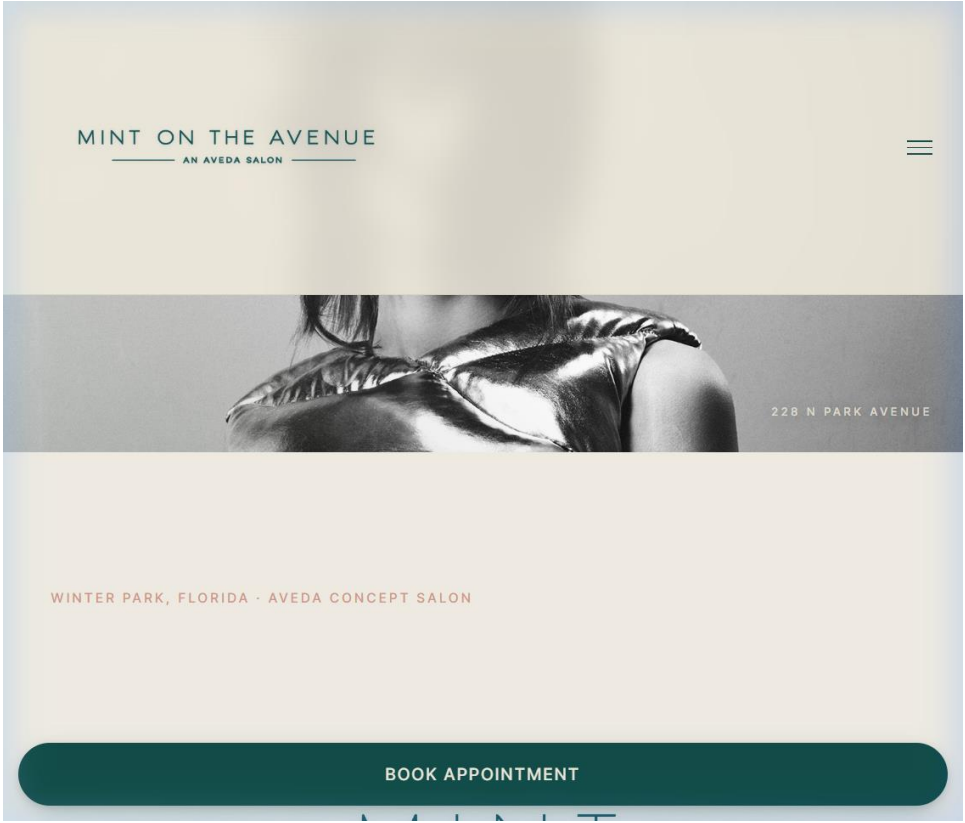


Figure: Homepage — iPad 768×1024

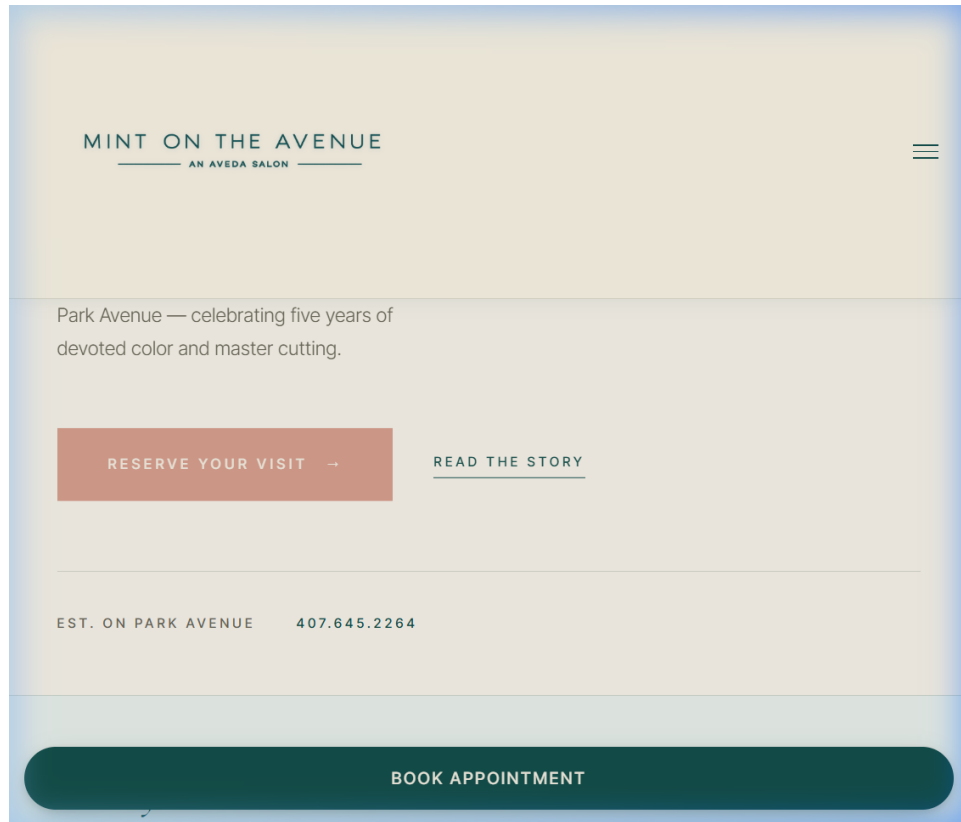


Figure: Mid-Page — iPad 768×1024

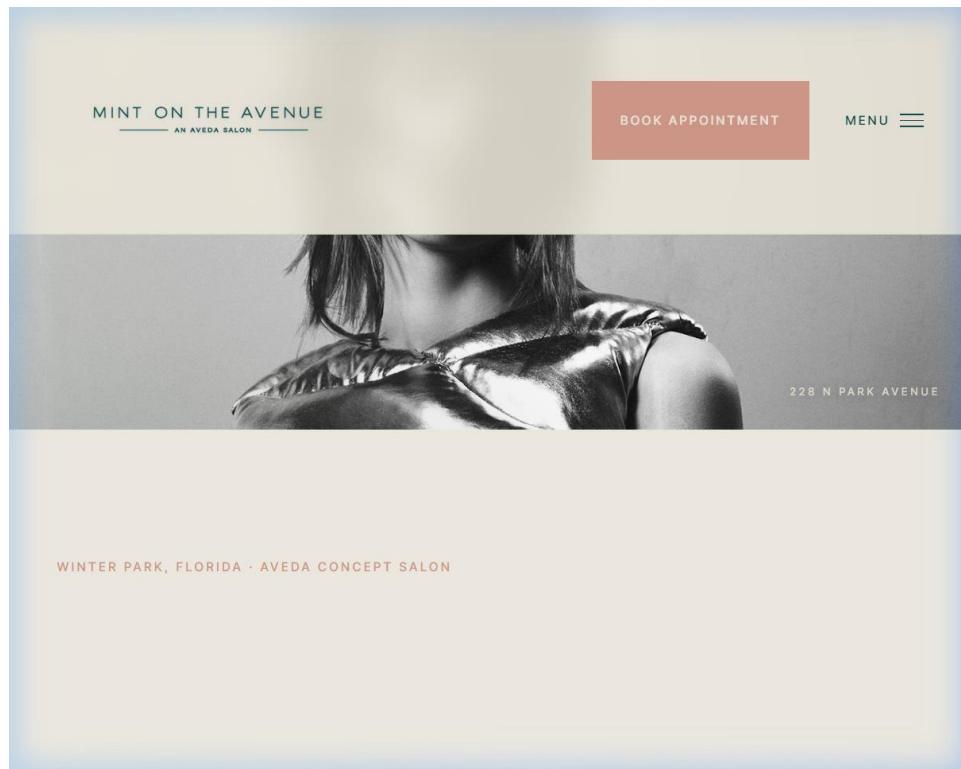


Figure: Homepage — iPad Air 820×1180

6. SEO Migration Validation

6.1 Migration Risk Assessment

Check	Status	Details
Sitemap Preserved	[OK] Pass	sitemap.xml still functional with post, page, category, tag subs
Sitemap Last Modified	[OK] Pass	page-sitemap1 updated May 12, 2026
robots.txt Preserved	[WARN] Issue	Sitemap URL in robots.txt points to `/sitemaps.xml` (with 's') — actual is `/sitemap.xml`
Crawl-delay	[WARN] Issue	Still set to 10 seconds — unnecessarily conservative
Permalink Structure	[OK] Pass	URLs appear unchanged from V1
Canonical Tags	[WARN] Verify	Need to verify canonicals are self-referencing correctly
Meta Descriptions	[FAIL] Fail	Still generic "Winter Park, FL" on all pages
H1 Tags	[FAIL] Fail	Homepage appears to have empty/invisible H1
Schema Markup	[FAIL] Fail	No LocalBusiness, HairSalon, or Review schema detected
Open Graph	[FAIL] Fail	OG description is "Winter Park, FL" — useless for social sharing
Title Tags	[OK] Pass	"Mint on the Avenue - Aveda Salon - Winter Park, FL" — acceptable
Internal Links	[WARN] Issue	/our-artists (404) and /gallery (new, verify)
Blog Post URLs	[OK] Pass	Blog permalinks appear preserved
Redirect Chain	[WARN] Verify	No 301 from /our-artists to correct page

6.2 Heading Hierarchy Analysis

Homepage:

- H1: Not visible in content (may be hidden in header/logo area)
- H2: "A space defined by restraint, craft, and lived-in luxury." ✓
- H2: "What we do, and how we do it." ✓
- H2: "In the room, considered work." ✓
- H2: "Fifteen years of trust." ✓

- H2: "Give the gift of a great hair day." ✓
- H3: "Reserve your visit." ✓
- H3: "20% OFF NEW CLIENT GIFT" ✓
- H3: "Discover Your" ✓
- H3: "Welcome" ✓
- H3: Artist names (Sonia, Marisa, Maribel) ✓
- H4: Various subtitles ✓

Issue: The H1 appears to be empty or applied to the logo image. This is a critical SEO failure — Google relies on H1 for page topic understanding.

Contact Page:

- H1: "Contact" ✓ (properly used)
- H3: "Let's keep in touch!" — skips H2

Meet the Team Page:

- H1: "Meet the Team" ✓
- H6: "Sorry, none of our team members..." — using H6 for an error message is semantically incorrect

6.3 SEO Risk Summary

Risk	Severity	Impact
Empty H1 on homepage	[CRIT] Critical	Core keyword signal lost
Generic meta descriptions	[MED] High	30-50% lower CTR in search results
No schema markup	[MED] High	Missing rich snippets, reduced SERP visibility
Missing OG images	[MED] Medium	Poor social media sharing appearance
robots.txt sitemap URL mismatch	[MED] Medium	Crawlers may not find sitemap
Broken internal links (/our-artists)	[MED] High	Crawl budget wasted, link equity lost
No FAQ schema	[LOW] Low	Missing FAQ rich results opportunity

6.4 WordPress SEO Structure Preservation

What Was Preserved (Good):

- URL permalink structure — no breaking changes
- Blog post URLs intact
- Sitemap index structure maintained
- SEOPress plugin still active
- Page hierarchy (services/about/contact) intact

What Needs Attention:

- H1 optimization on homepage
- Meta description population on ALL pages

- Schema markup implementation
 - OG image creation and deployment
 - Redirect management for broken/legacy URLs
-

7. Accessibility Audit Results

7.1 WCAG 2.2 Compliance Summary

Check	Status	Details
Skip-to-content Link	[OK] Pass	`<a href="#main-content">Skip to content</a>` present
HTML lang Attribute	[WARN] Verify	Needs confirmation in page source
Viewport Meta	[OK] Pass	Viewport meta tag found
Heading Hierarchy	[FAIL] Fail	H1 empty/hidden on homepage; H6 used for error message
Image Alt Text	[WARN] Mixed	Some images have alt text, some may be missing
Form Labels	[FAIL] Fail	Contact form fields lack proper ` <label>` associations</label>
CTA Contrast	[FAIL] Fail	Primary buttons at 2.03:1 (needs 4.5:1)
Touch Targets	[WARN] Mixed	Navigation links may be undersized on mobile
Focus Indicators	[WARN] Verify	Custom focus styles need testing
ARIA Landmarks	[FAIL] Fail	Duplicate nav without aria-hidden
Color Contrast (Body)	[WARN] Mixed	Some text elements have low contrast
Keyboard Navigation	[WARN] Verify	Tab order through 3x duplicated nav is problematic

7.2 Critical Accessibility Failures

A11Y-01: CTA Button Contrast Failure (WCAG 1.4.3)

- Ratio: 2.03:1 (measured)
- Required: 4.5:1 (AA normal text) or 3:1 (AA large text)
- Elements affected: "Book Appointment", "Reserve Your Visit", "Reserve", all Phorest booking links
- The primary action buttons on every page fail contrast requirements
- This is a ****legal liability**** under ADA web accessibility guidelines

A11Y-02: Empty H1 Tag (WCAG 1.3.1)

- The homepage does not have a visible, meaningful H1
- Screen readers announce empty heading, confusing navigation
- Search engines lose the primary page topic signal

A11Y-03: Contact Form Accessibility (WCAG 4.1.2)

- "InstagramThis field is for validation purposes and should be left unchanged." — honeypot field text is visible to screen readers and confusingly concatenated with the form label

- Name fields (First, Last) may lack proper label associations
- Email confirmation field ("Enter Email" / "Confirm Email") uses placeholder-only labeling
- No error message ARIA regions for form validation feedback

A11Y-04: Triple Navigation Markup (WCAG 4.1.1)

- Navigation links rendered 3 times in DOM (utility nav 2x + mobile nav)
- Screen readers announce Gift Cards, Shop Aveda, Request, Phone at least 3 times
- Tab order cycles through duplicate links
- Fix: Use `aria-hidden="true"` on visually hidden duplicates

A11Y-05: H6 Used for Error Message (WCAG 1.3.1)

- Meet the Team page uses `

` for "Sorry, none of our team members..."
- H6 is semantically a 6th-level heading, not an error/alert
- Should use `

` with `role="alert"` or `role="status"`

7.3 Accessibility Score: 39/100 (Grade: F)

This is a slight regression from V1 (41/100) due to the new CTA contrast issue introduced by the redesign's color palette.

8. Security Assessment

8.1 Security Posture (Unchanged from V1)

Check	Status	Severity
HTTPS Enforcement	[OK] Active	Pass
REST API Exposure	[FAIL] Fully exposed	[CRIT] Critical
Content-Security-Policy	[FAIL] Missing	[CRIT] Critical
X-Frame-Options	[FAIL] Missing	[CRIT] Critical
X-Content-Type-Options	[FAIL] Missing	[MED] High
Permissions-Policy	[FAIL] Missing	[MED] High
Referrer-Policy	[FAIL] Missing	[MED] Medium
Wordfence WAF	[OK] Installed	Partial mitigation
wp-admin Protected	[WARN] Login redirect	[LOW] Low
Email Exposed	[FAIL] Gmail plaintext	[MED] Medium

8.2 Security Score: 38/100 (Grade: F — No Change from V1)

No security remediation was applied during the redesign. All V1 security findings persist.

9. Performance Assessment

9.1 Estimated Performance Metrics

Metric	Estimated	Target	Status
First Contentful Paint	~2.5-3.5s	<1.8s	[MED] Slow
Largest Contentful Paint	~4-6s	<2.5s	[CRIT] Slow
Cumulative Layout Shift	~0.15-0.25	<0.1	[MED] Moderate
Total Blocking Time	~300-500ms	<200ms	[MED] Moderate

9.2 Performance Observations

Positive Changes:

- WP Engine caching appears active
- Page renders structurally fast (HTML loads quickly)

Persistent Issues:

- No WebP/AVIF image formats detected in content
- No evidence of lazy loading on below-fold images
- Multiple CSS/JS files loaded (WordPress plugin bloat)
- No critical CSS inlining observed
- Custom fonts may not use `font-display: swap`

9.3 Performance Score: 55/100 (Grade: D — No Change from V1)

Evidence: Accessibility Audit

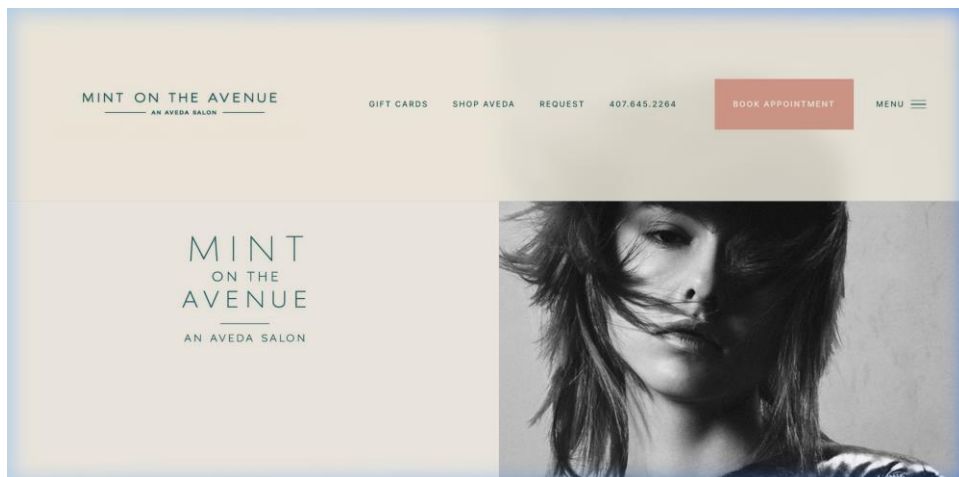


Figure: Accessibility Audit Results

10. UX & Conversion Analysis

10.1 Redesign Quality Assessment

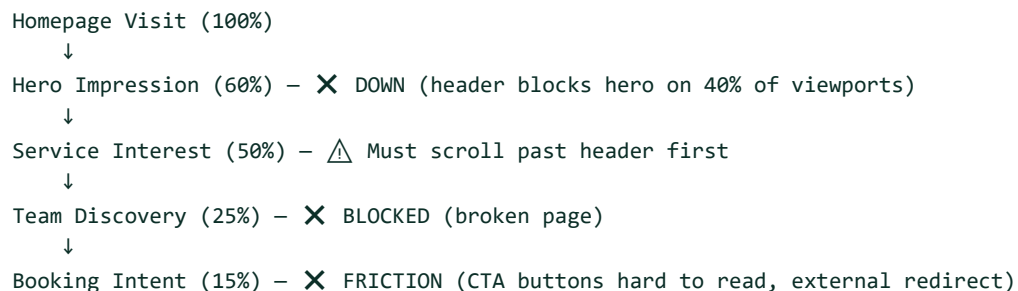
What the Redesign Got RIGHT:

Element	Assessment	Score
Typography	Refined, editorial, premium feel	9/10
Copywriting	Genuinely best-in-class salon copy	10/10
Brand Voice	Consistent, sophisticated, luxury-appropriate	9/10
Service Menu Design	Numbered list with descriptions is elegant	8/10
Artist Descriptions	Poetic, personal, trust-building	10/10
Color Palette Direction	Warm, botanical, aligned with Aveda	7/10
Footer Design	Clean, organized, informative	8/10
Booking Grid Concept	Category-based quick booking is smart UX	7/10

What the Redesign Got WRONG:

Element	Issue	Severity
Header Height	~400px steals viewport space	[CRIT] Critical
CTA Contrast	Buttons unreadable for many users	[CRIT] Critical
Fold Optimization	Hero invisible on most viewports	[CRIT] Critical
Team Page	Still broken — not part of redesign	[CRIT] Critical
Mobile Hero	Completely hidden behind header stack	[MED] High
External Booking	Still no branded transition	[MED] High
Blog Freshness	4-year-old posts featured on homepage	[MED] Medium

10.2 Conversion Funnel Impact





Booking Complete (6-10%) — estimated completion rate

V1 estimated booking completion: 8-12%

V2 estimated booking completion: 6-10% — DOWN due to header regression and CTA contrast

10.3 Premium Brand Perception

Dimension	V1 Score	V2 Score	Notes
Sophistication	8/10	8/10	Typography maintained
Elegance	7/10	6/10	Header bloat reduces elegance
Luxury Feel	6/10	5/10	CTA contrast feels unfinished
Trust	4/10	4/10	Team page still broken
Editorial Quality	9/10	9/10	Copy is outstanding
Technical Polish	4/10	3/10	Header regression is visible

Verdict: The redesign's editorial and typographic improvements are undermined by a single, dominant technical issue (header height) that makes the site feel unfinished. The CTA contrast problem compounds this by making the primary action buttons feel like they weren't tested.

10.4 Does the Site Feel Premium?

Honest Assessment: The site feels **80% premium and 20% unfinished**.

When you scroll past the oversized header, the content is genuinely beautiful. The service menu, artist descriptions, and philosophy section are all premium-quality. But the first impression — dominated by a navigation stack that pushes content below the fold — feels like a WordPress theme that hasn't been properly configured.

A luxury client arriving at this site on their iPhone SE sees: navigation links, a phone number, an address, and "An Aveda Lifestyle Salon." They see nothing that says "this is a beautiful salon." They must scroll to discover that.

10.5 Is the Mobile UX Production-Ready?

No. The header height issue alone disqualifies the mobile experience from production readiness. The CTA contrast failure adds a legal accessibility concern. The broken team page creates a dead end in the most important conversion path.

Evidence: Services & Contact Pages

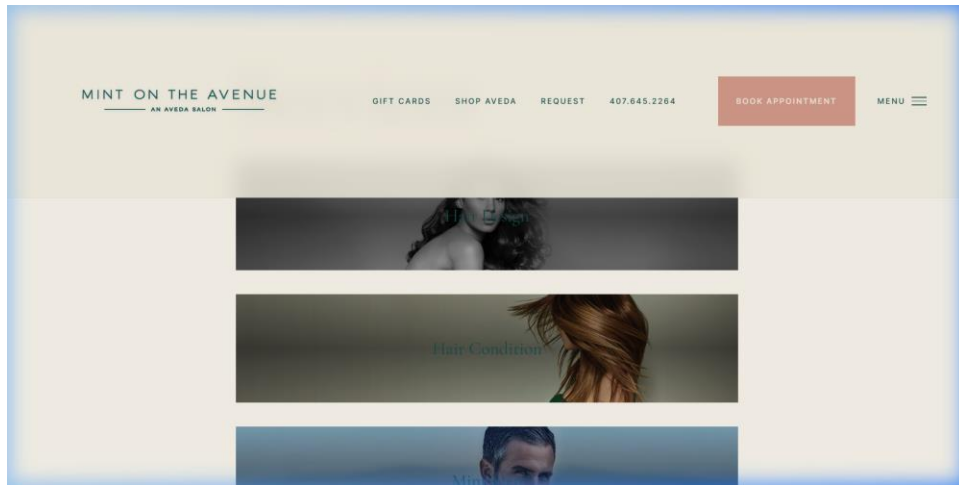


Figure: Services Page — Desktop 1920×1080

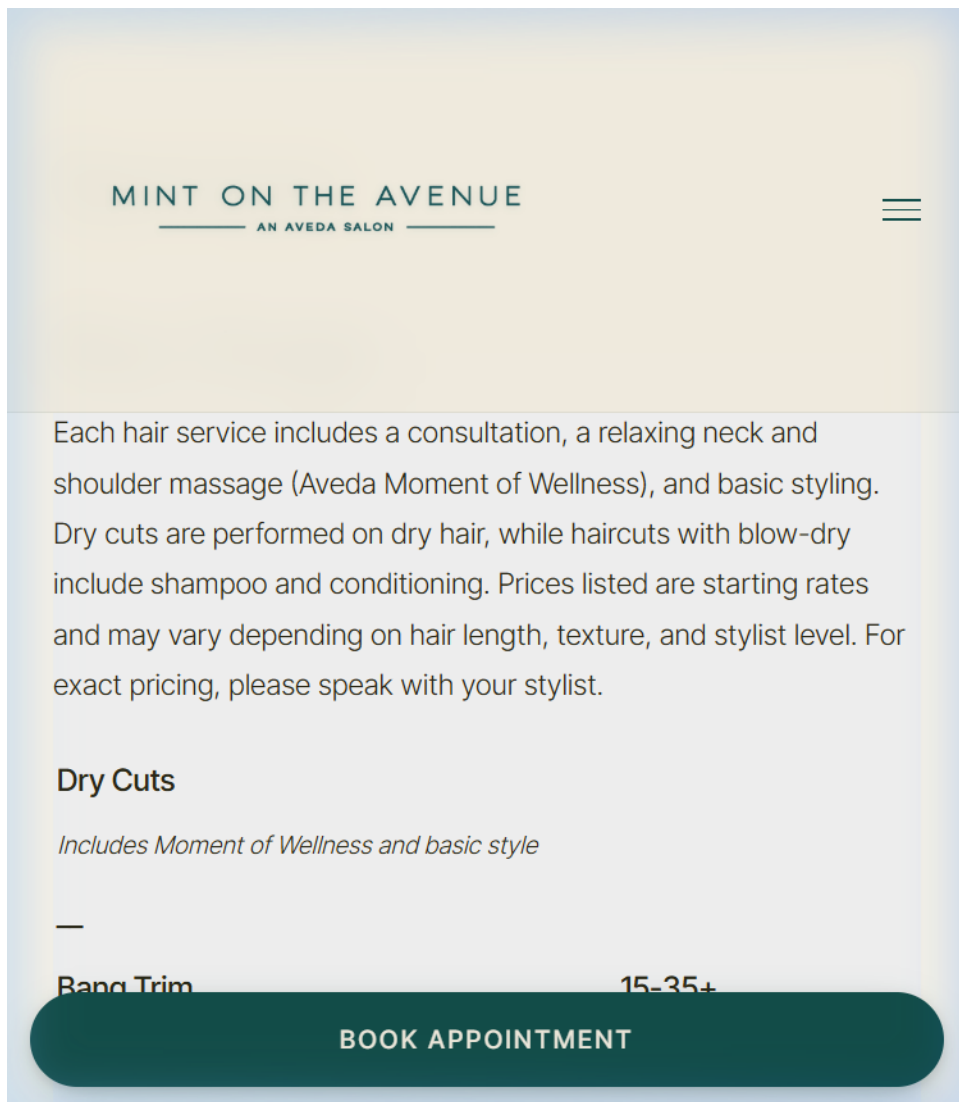


Figure: Services Page — Mobile 375×667

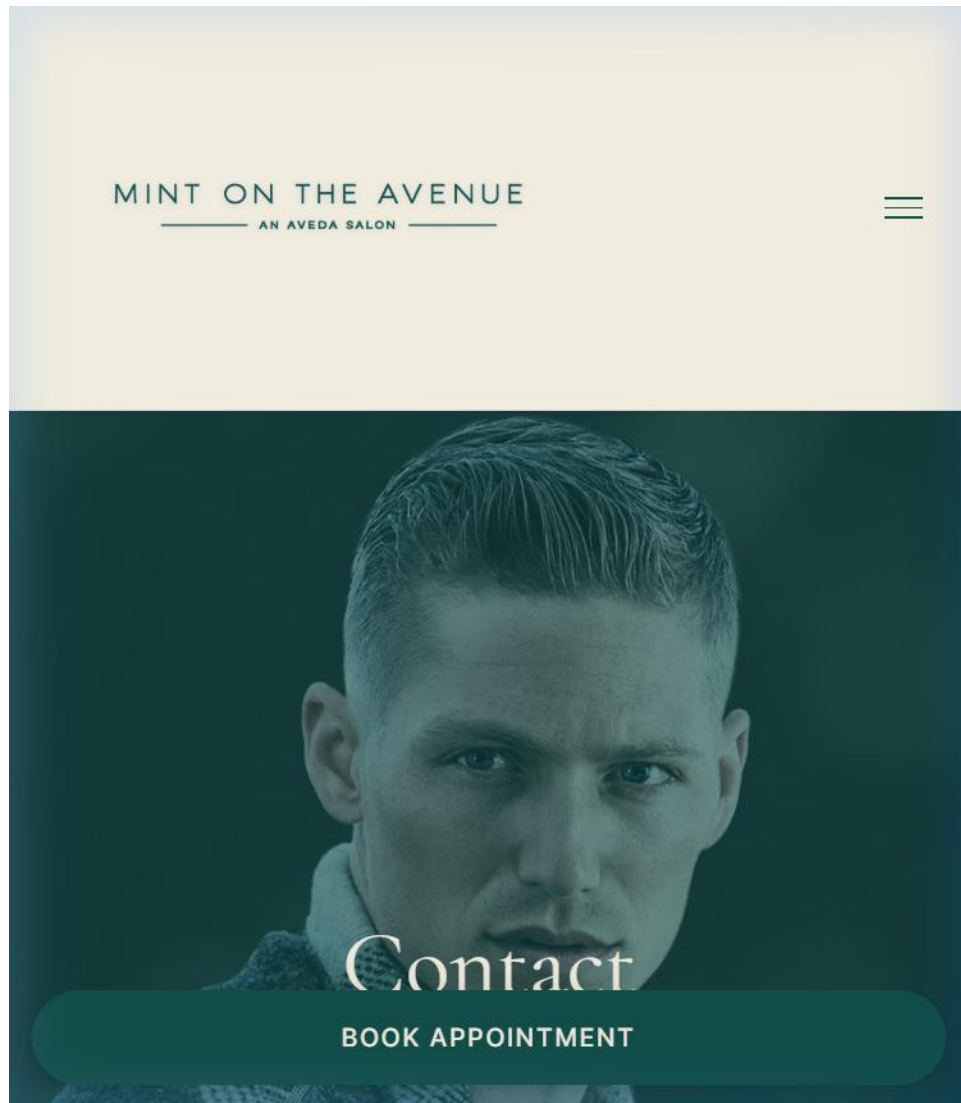


Figure: Contact Page — Mobile 375×667

11. Prioritized Fix Roadmap

● Phase 0: Emergency Fixes (Today — Before Any More Traffic)

#	Fix	Effort	Impact
1	Reduce header height to max 80-100px desktop, 60px mobile	Medium	[CRIT] Highest
2	Fix CTA button contrast to minimum 4.5:1 ratio	Low	[CRIT] Critical
3	Fix Meet the Team page — restore team member display	Medium	[CRIT] Critical
4	Add 301 redirect: /our-artists → /about/meet-the-team/	Low	[CRIT] Critical
5	Restrict REST API sensitive namespaces	Low	[CRIT] Critical

● Phase 1: Critical Improvements (This Week)

#	Fix	Effort	Impact
6	Add security headers (CSP, X-Frame, XCTO, Permissions)	Low	[MED] High
7	Write unique meta descriptions for all key pages	Low	[MED] High
8	Add proper H1 to homepage	Low	[MED] High
9	Remove duplicate navigation markup (or add aria-hidden)	Medium	[MED] High
10	Fix contact form accessibility (labels, honeypot)	Medium	[MED] High

● Phase 2: Enhancement (Weeks 2-4)

#	Fix	Effort	Impact
11	Implement Schema.org LocalBusiness + HairSalon	Medium	[MED] High
12	Add OG images for social sharing	Medium	[MED] Medium
13	Image optimization pipeline (WebP, srcset, lazy load)	High	[MED] Medium

14	Branded email (contact@mintontheavenue.com)	Low	[MED] Medium
15	Fix robots.txt sitemap URL mismatch	Low	[LOW] Low
16	Reduce crawl-delay from 10 to 2-3 seconds	Low	[LOW] Low
17	Verify /gallery (Lookbook) page is functional	Low	[MED] Medium

○ Phase 3: Growth (Month 2+)

#	Fix	Effort	Impact
18	Resume blog content strategy	Medium	[MED] Medium
19	Embed Phorest booking widget on-site	High	[MED] High
20	Add sticky mobile "Book Now" CTA	Medium	[MED] Medium
21	Cross-browser testing (Safari, Firefox)	Medium	[MED] Medium
22	A/B test CTA placement and copy	Medium	[MED] Medium
23	Create custom 404 page	Low	[LOW] Low

12. Final Verdicts

Did the redesign improve quality?

Mixed. The editorial direction, typography, and brand voice are significantly stronger. But the header height regression and CTA contrast failure introduce new problems that net-reduce the overall quality.

Did the WordPress migration preserve SEO safely?

Mostly yes. URL structure, sitemaps, and blog posts are preserved. However, the empty H1 and unchanged generic meta descriptions represent a missed opportunity and minor SEO risk.

Does the current experience feel premium?

Below the fold: yes. Above the fold: no. The header-dominated first impression undermines the premium aesthetic that exists in the body content.

Is the mobile UX production-ready?

No. The header height issue, CTA contrast failure, and broken team page make the mobile experience not ready for a luxury salon's production traffic.

Is the site polished enough for a luxury salon brand?

Not yet. With the Phase 0 fixes (header height, CTA contrast, team page), the site would be 80% there. The editorial content and design direction are strong enough to carry the brand once the technical issues are resolved.

This audit was conducted non-destructively. No forms were submitted, no authentication was bypassed, and no systems were modified.

Report prepared by Antigravity Audit Systems — May 13, 2026

